

D018

# Leading Inclusive Schools

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

**What this is.** Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

**Source.** Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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# How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

|                             |                                           |                        |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>_____ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|

# Items

1.

A parent who works as a pediatric nurse brings a doctor's ADHD diagnosis for her son and asks for an IEP. The boy earns A's and B's, has no behavior referrals, and is in the school's award-winning choir. What determines whether he qualifies under IDEA?

- A. The diagnosis alone, since ADHD is a recognized disability.
- B. Whether the disability causes a need for specially designed instruction, which his record does not currently suggest.
- C. The parent's medical expertise.
- D. He can never qualify, because his grades are good.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

2.

A student with Type 1 diabetes at a school with a full-time nurse and a new cafeteria needs scheduled snacks, blood-sugar checks and extra time on tests after a low reading. She performs at grade level. Which plan fits best?

- A. A behavior intervention plan.
- B. A Section 504 plan with accommodations.
- C. An IEP under IDEA.
- D. No plan, because the school has a full-time nurse.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student with a specific learning disability reads three years below grade level and needs daily specialized reading instruction. Which plan fits?

- A. A gifted education plan.
- B. An English learner plan.
- C. An IEP under IDEA.
- D. A Section 504 plan only.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

4.

A district with a new special education wing proposes placing every student with an intellectual disability in a separate classroom there, because the wing has space and a trained teacher. One student currently makes good progress in a general education class with a paraprofessional. What should the leader do?

- A. Place students by disability category.
- B. Move all such students to the wing, because it has space.
- C. Keep every student in general education full time no matter what.
- D. Keep the student in general education with supports, since that placement is working; decide each student's placement individually.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

5.

A student with an IEP for an emotional disability pushes a classmate during a heated argument in the newly opened library. It is the student's third incident, and suspensions this year already total 8 school days. The principal wants a 5-day suspension. What must happen?

- A. A review is needed only if the incident happened in the library.
- B. Suspend as the code says; students with IEPs follow the same code.
- C. The student cannot be suspended at all because of the IEP.
- D. Hold a manifestation determination review within 10 school days of the decision, because total removals would exceed 10 days.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manifestation team finds that a student's behavior was directly caused by his disability. No weapons, drugs or serious injury were involved. What happens next?

- A. Return the student to his placement and conduct or review a functional behavioral assessment and behavior plan.
- B. Move the student to a 45-day alternative setting.
- C. Proceed with the long-term suspension.
- D. Remove the student's IEP.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

7.

Fall screening at an elementary school that recently adopted a new math series shows 45% of third graders below benchmark in reading. The school has a large, well-trained intervention team. What does this pattern suggest?

- A. Strengthen Tier 1 core reading instruction, since a healthy core usually leaves about 80% of students on track.
- B. Refer all 45% for special education.
- C. Use the intervention team for math instead.
- D. Place all 45% in Tier 3.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A parent submits a written request for a special education evaluation. The student has been in Tier 2 reading intervention for three weeks. What should the school do?

- A. Respond within required timelines: begin the evaluation with consent, or give written notice explaining any refusal; the intervention continues alongside.
- B. Ignore it; only teachers can request evaluations.
- C. Wait until the student finishes all three tiers.
- D. Deny the request because Tier 2 has only lasted three weeks.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

9.

A seventh grader who arrived from abroad four months ago, and who plays chess at a high level, struggles to read the science textbook and rarely speaks in class. His teacher suggests a special education referral. What should the leader do first?

- A. Refer him immediately for special education.
- B. Place him in gifted classes because of his chess.
- C. Confirm EL identification and language support, and look at progress with language services before considering a disability.
- D. Wait until he is fluent before offering any support.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**10.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

At enrollment, a family's home language survey shows a language other than English. What should the school do next?

- A.** Refer the student for a special education evaluation.
- B.** Do nothing unless the parents ask for help.
- C.** Label the student an English learner based on the survey alone.
- D.** Give an English language proficiency screener to decide whether the student is an English learner.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**11.**

A fifth grader with dyslexia, who attends the school's popular after-school robotics club, scores in the 98th percentile in math reasoning but reads below grade level. The gifted program admits students only by a single reading-heavy test. What is the concern?

- A.** She cannot be gifted because she has a disability.
- B.** Serve only her dyslexia and ignore the math strength.
- C.** She may be twice-exceptional; identification should use multiple measures, and she needs support for both her giftedness and her dyslexia.
- D.** Admit her based on robotics club participation.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**12.**

A district with a new strategic plan and strong test scores finds that one student group makes up 15% of enrollment but 40% of students identified with emotional disabilities. The group's families are active in the PTA. What should leaders do?

- A.** Accept the numbers as reflecting real differences among students.
- B.** Review referral, evaluation and identification practices for possible bias and act on what is found.
- C.** Ask the PTA to explain the numbers.
- D.** Stop identifying any students from that group.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

# STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

# Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

## 1. Answer B Concept 1

A parent ~~who works as a pediatric nurse~~ brings a doctor's ADHD diagnosis for her son and asks for an IEP. The boy earns A's and B's, has no behavior referrals, ~~and is in the school's award-winning choir~~. What determines whether he qualifies under IDEA?

**Target word:** eligibility test **Decides:** A disability plus a need for specially designed instruction.

|          |                   |                                                                                       |
|----------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Dropped element   | Leaves out the second prong: need for specially designed instruction.                 |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | IDEA eligibility needs both a qualifying disability and a need for special education. |
| C        | Camouflage        | Her profession does not decide eligibility.                                           |
| D        | Absolute language | Grades alone do not rule out need; the team evaluates.                                |

## 2. Answer B Concept 2

A student with Type 1 diabetes at a school ~~with a full-time nurse and a new cafeteria~~ needs scheduled snacks, blood-sugar checks and extra time on tests after a low reading. She performs at grade level. Which plan fits best?

**Target word:** which plan **Decides:** Needs access accommodations, not specialized instruction.

|          |                   |                                                                                                    |
|----------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Confusion set     | There is no behavior concern.                                                                      |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Her impairment limits a major life activity; she needs access, not specially designed instruction. |
| C        | Adjacent category | An IEP is for students who need specially designed instruction.                                    |
| D        | Camouflage        | Staffing does not replace the student's legal right to accommodations.                             |

## 3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

A student with a specific learning disability reads three years below grade level and needs daily specialized reading instruction. Which plan fits?

**Target word:** which plan **Decides:** Needs specially designed instruction.

|          |                    |                                                               |
|----------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category  | Does not address the reading disability.                      |
| B        | Confusion set      | Nothing suggests the need is language acquisition.            |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Specially designed instruction is provided through an IEP.    |
| D        | Inverted operation | 504 gives access accommodations, not specialized instruction. |

## 4. Answer D Concept 3

A district with a new special education wing proposes placing every student with an intellectual disability in a separate classroom there, ~~because the wing has space and a trained teacher~~. One student currently makes good progress in a general education class with a paraprofessional. What should the leader do?

**Target word:** placement decision **Decides:** Placement is individual and must be the least restrictive environment that works.

|          |                   |                                                                           |
|----------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category | Placement must be individual, not by label.                               |
| B        | Camouflage        | Space and convenience do not justify removal.                             |
| C        | Absolute language | LRE is maximum appropriate inclusion, not a ban on other settings.        |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Removal is justified only when supports in general education cannot work. |

## 5. Answer D Concept 4

A student with an IEP for an emotional disability pushes a classmate during a heated argument in the newly opened library. It is the student's third incident, and suspensions this year already total 8 school days. The principal wants a 5-day suspension. What must happen?

**Target word:** required step **Decides:**  $8 + 5 = 13$  days, more than 10: a manifestation determination is required.

|   |                   |                                                                      |
|---|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Camouflage        | Location does not decide the requirement.                            |
| B | Dropped element   | Leaves out the review required after 10 days.                        |
| C | Absolute language | Students with IEPs can be disciplined within IDEA's protections.     |
| D | <b>Correct</b>    | The pattern and total create a change of placement requiring review. |

## 6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A manifestation team finds that a student's behavior was directly caused by his disability. No weapons, drugs or serious injury were involved. What happens next?

**Target word:** result of a yes finding **Decides:** A manifestation means return to placement and address the behavior.

|   |                    |                                                                                                |
|---|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>     | When the behavior is a manifestation, the student returns and the team addresses the behavior. |
| B | Adjacent category  | That is the special-circumstances rule for weapons, drugs or serious bodily injury.            |
| C | Inverted operation | That follows a no-manifestation finding.                                                       |
| D | Absolute language  | Eligibility is not affected by the finding.                                                    |

## 7. Answer A Concept 5

Fall screening at an elementary school that recently adopted a new math series shows 45% of third graders below benchmark in reading. The school has a large, well-trained intervention team. What does this pattern suggest?

**Target word:** which tier to address **Decides:** When many students struggle, core Tier 1 instruction needs attention.

|   |                    |                                                             |
|---|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>     | Widespread need points to the core, not individuals.        |
| B | Inverted operation | Treats a core-instruction problem as individual disability. |
| C | Camouflage         | Answers the new math series, not the reading data.          |
| D | Adjacent category  | Tier 3 is for a small share needing intensive help.         |

## 8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A parent submits a written request for a special education evaluation. The student has been in Tier 2 reading intervention for three weeks. What should the school do?

**Target word:** response to evaluation request **Decides:** MTSS cannot delay or deny a requested evaluation.

|   |                    |                                                                        |
|---|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>     | MTSS may not be used to delay an evaluation.                           |
| B | Absolute language  | Parents may request an evaluation.                                     |
| C | Inverted operation | Treats MTSS as a required waiting period.                              |
| D | Wrong stem number  | The intervention length does not decide the parent's right to request. |

## 9. Answer C Concept 6

A seventh grader who arrived from abroad four months ago, ~~and who plays chess at a high level~~, struggles to read the science textbook and rarely speaks in class. His teacher suggests a special education referral. What should the leader do first?

**Target word:** first step **Decides:** Limited English proficiency is not a disability.

|          |                    |                                                          |
|----------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category  | Confuses language acquisition with disability.           |
| B        | Camouflage         | Answers the chess detail, not the language need.         |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Struggles may reflect second-language learning.          |
| D        | Inverted operation | ELs must receive language support to access content now. |

## 10. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

At enrollment, a family's home language survey shows a language other than English. What should the school do next?

**Target word:** next identification step **Decides:** The survey triggers a language proficiency screener.

|          |                   |                                            |
|----------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| A        | Confusion set     | Home language is not a sign of disability. |
| B        | Absolute language | Schools must identify ELs proactively.     |
| C        | Dropped element   | Leaves out the proficiency assessment.     |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | The survey flags; the screener identifies. |

## 11. Answer C Concept 7

A fifth grader with dyslexia, ~~who attends the school's popular after-school robotics club~~, scores in the 98th percentile in math reasoning but reads below grade level. The gifted program admits students only by a single reading-heavy test. What is the concern?

**Target word:** identification concern **Decides:** A twice-exceptional student can be missed by a single, reading-heavy measure.

|          |                   |                                                            |
|----------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Absolute language | Students can be both gifted and disabled.                  |
| B        | Dropped element   | Leaves out support for her strength.                       |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Single measures can hide strengths masked by a disability. |
| D        | Camouflage        | Club membership is not an identification measure.          |

## 12. Answer B Concept 8

A district ~~with a new strategic plan and strong test scores~~ finds that one student group makes up 15% of enrollment but 40% of students identified with emotional disabilities. ~~The group's families are active in the PTA.~~ What should leaders do?

**Target word:** response to disproportionality **Decides:** 40% vs. 15% signals possible bias in identification.

|          |                    |                                                          |
|----------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Inverted operation | Assumes rates reflect students rather than practice.     |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Large over-representation calls for a procedural review. |
| C        | Camouflage         | PTA involvement does not address district procedures.    |
| D        | Absolute language  | Students with genuine needs must still be served.        |

## Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

|                       | <b>Right</b>                                          | <b>Wrong</b>                                                                          |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sure</b>           | Owned.                                                | <b>Concept inversion — top priority.</b> A wrong mental model; it survives rewording. |
| <b>Unsure / guess</b> | Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer. | Not learned yet.                                                                      |

## Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

| <b>Trap</b>        | <b>What it does</b>                                          | <b>In this drill</b> | <b>Your misses</b> |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| Dropped element    | Leaves out a required term or step.                          | 4                    |                    |
| Wrong stem number  | A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.      | 1                    |                    |
| Adjacent category  | The right idea in the wrong bucket.                          | 6                    |                    |
| Inverted operation | Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower. | 6                    |                    |
| Absolute language  | Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.           | 8                    |                    |
| Confusion set      | Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.       | 3                    |                    |
| Camouflage         | Answers a stem fact that was never the question.             | 8                    |                    |

## Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

| # | Concept                                   | Rule                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Trap                                                                                                          | Tell                                                                   |
|---|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>IDEA eligibility has two parts</b>     | A student qualifies for special education under IDEA only if the student has a disability in one of the listed categories and, because of it, needs specially designed instruction.                                                                                                 | Assuming a medical diagnosis alone makes a student eligible.                                                  | A diagnosis and good or poor progress in the general curriculum.       |
| 2 | <b>IDEA vs. Section 504</b>               | Section 504 protects students whose impairment substantially limits a major life activity and provides accommodations for equal access; IDEA provides an IEP with specially designed instruction for students who need it.                                                          | Treating a 504 plan and an IEP as the same thing.                                                             | A student who needs access supports but not specialized instruction.   |
| 3 | <b>Least restrictive environment</b>      | Students with disabilities are educated with nondisabled peers to the maximum extent appropriate; removal happens only when supplementary aids and services in general education cannot work satisfactorily.                                                                        | Placing a student by category or by program convenience.                                                      | A placement decision based on label, space, or staffing.               |
| 4 | <b>Manifestation determination</b>        | When a disciplinary removal of a student with a disability would exceed 10 school days (a change of placement), the team must decide within 10 school days whether the behavior was caused by or directly related to the disability, or resulted from failure to implement the IEP. | Applying the regular discipline code with no review, or thinking students with IEPs can never be disciplined. | A long suspension or expulsion for a student with an IEP.              |
| 5 | <b>MTSS tiers and data-based movement</b> | Tier 1 is strong core instruction for all, Tier 2 adds targeted small-group support, and Tier 3 is intensive, individualized support; progress-monitoring data decide movement, and MTSS may not delay a requested special education evaluation.                                    | Using MTSS as a required waiting period before evaluation, or starting interventions without data.            | Screening data, intervention groups, and a request for evaluation.     |
| 6 | <b>Serving English learners</b>           | Schools must identify English learners (home language survey plus a proficiency screener) and provide language instruction so they can access the curriculum; limited English alone is not a disability.                                                                            | Referring a student to special education because of limited English.                                          | A newcomer or EL whose struggles may reflect language, not disability. |

| # | Concept                                      | Rule                                                                                                                                                                                       | Trap                                                                           | Tell                                                                       |
|---|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7 | <b>Gifted and twice-exceptional students</b> | Gifted identification should use multiple measures to reduce bias, and twice-exceptional students need support for both their strengths and their disability.                              | Assuming a student cannot be both gifted and disabled, or relying on one test. | Uneven performance: high ability in one area with a disability in another. |
| 8 | <b>Disproportionality and equity</b>         | Leaders review identification, placement and discipline data by student group; large over- or under-representation signals possible bias in practice and calls for a review of procedures. | Assuming differences in rates simply reflect differences in students.          | Rates by subgroup compared to enrollment share.                            |

**Course scope (public description):** Leading Inclusive Schools covers a variety of topics that directly affect students who have been assessed and determined to need additional support or services to ensure their academic success and well-being. The course prepares candidates to understand and comply with applicable laws, rights, policies, and regulations as appropriate to address matters of equity, fairness, and student marginalization based on culture and language, disability, or giftedness. These include types of special education classifications and their significance, working with English learners (ELs), working with gifted and talented students, and using Multi-Tiered System of Supports (MTSS) frameworks to ensure optimum learning environments for diverse learners. This course will guide candidates in building a strong repertoire of skills and knowledge related to exceptional students. It will help them ensure that each student has equitable access to effective teachers; learning opportunities; academic, social, and behavioral support; and other resources necessary for success. This course is designed to be taken after successful completion of the School Law course.